

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3194

Name

Emily Wissel

Emailemily.wissel6@gmail.com**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Galveston, Texas, United States

Nationality

U.S. citizen

When did or will you finish your PhD?

May 2023

University Education

PhD | Microbiome Bioinformatics / Nursing | Emory University | May 2023

Bachelors of Science | Psychology | The University of Texas at Austin | 2017

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

Science Corps is focused on both teaching and building resources, so the host community can continue to grow after the fellow leaves the host site. To me, this is a key component of any equity-minded job to ensure there are true benefits to the community one works with. Being a Science Corps fellow would give me the opportunity to help build equitable STEM education materials and contribute to the next generation of scientists. I find teaching and mentorship extremely fulfilling work and want to build my career in this direction, but I have not been able to focus on these as the conventional academic path is highly focused on research and publications. Further, I consider being a fellow with Science Corps as “walking the walk” in equity

based STEM work. Much of the equity work I have done has been scientists talking to other scientists, or teaching scientists how to partner with communities they are already researching. This work doesn't address global inequities in science and doesn't contribute to the communities impacted by this inequity. Science Corps is a unique program that is able to bridge this gap, and I would be honored to work as a Science Corps Fellow.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

I joined a group called the Microbes & Social Equity (MSE) working group in 2020 and am highly involved in MSE, helping to plan 3 virtual conferences and 2 Spring Speaker Series, managing their Twitter page, and contributing to several publications and conference presentations. In MSE, there are conversations about how we teach, what we teach, and why. I integrated these perspectives into my own (albeit limited) teaching experience, particularly through guest lectures and as a teaching assistant to Microbiology for Nurses. I received positive feedback on these courses. I've also mentored undergraduate researchers from underrepresented backgrounds and focused on skills-based mentorship as opposed to project-based mentorship. I find this approach is much more meaningful to my mentees and they finish the internship period with better developed projects and more confidence in themselves. On a non-science note, I've worked with kids for a long time! I taught How to Ride a Bike classes to kids (4 and up) with REI from 2017-2020. While I haven't taught this age group in a classroom, I am familiar with working with kids and keeping them engaged.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education

In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

I've been doing independent-based research for years now, including before my PhD program. I find that I am my happiest and most productive in people-facing roles as opposed to solely computer-facing roles. I like talking with people about their experiences and seeing how my work contributes to their goals, which is difficult with publication-focused work. I see my short-term professional development moving towards either education or outreach, and I believe I have a good skill set for administration or project management in these roles. I also would like additional training in these roles as my training to date is research-focused. In the near-term vision, I may be required to make several more "big" moves before I have the opportunity to work in a community long-term. In my long-term vision, I have moved outside of the United States and am working to lift up my local community and give a platform to voices traditionally excluded from academic institutions and research. I will have worked with one community for many years and am working to train others in the skills I have developed over the years. I hope that I will also develop open-access resources in these domains.

CV/Resume

 [Wissel CV ScienceCorps.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Job board

Any other comments/questions?

I would like to start Fall/Winter 2023. My ideal site placement would be Central Visayan Institute Foundation in Jagna, Philippines, but I am open to other sites.

I have two cats that will be moving with me, but I have no other restrictions on dates or moving. I am currently vegan but my diet will be flexible to what is locally available.

[Science Corps](#)